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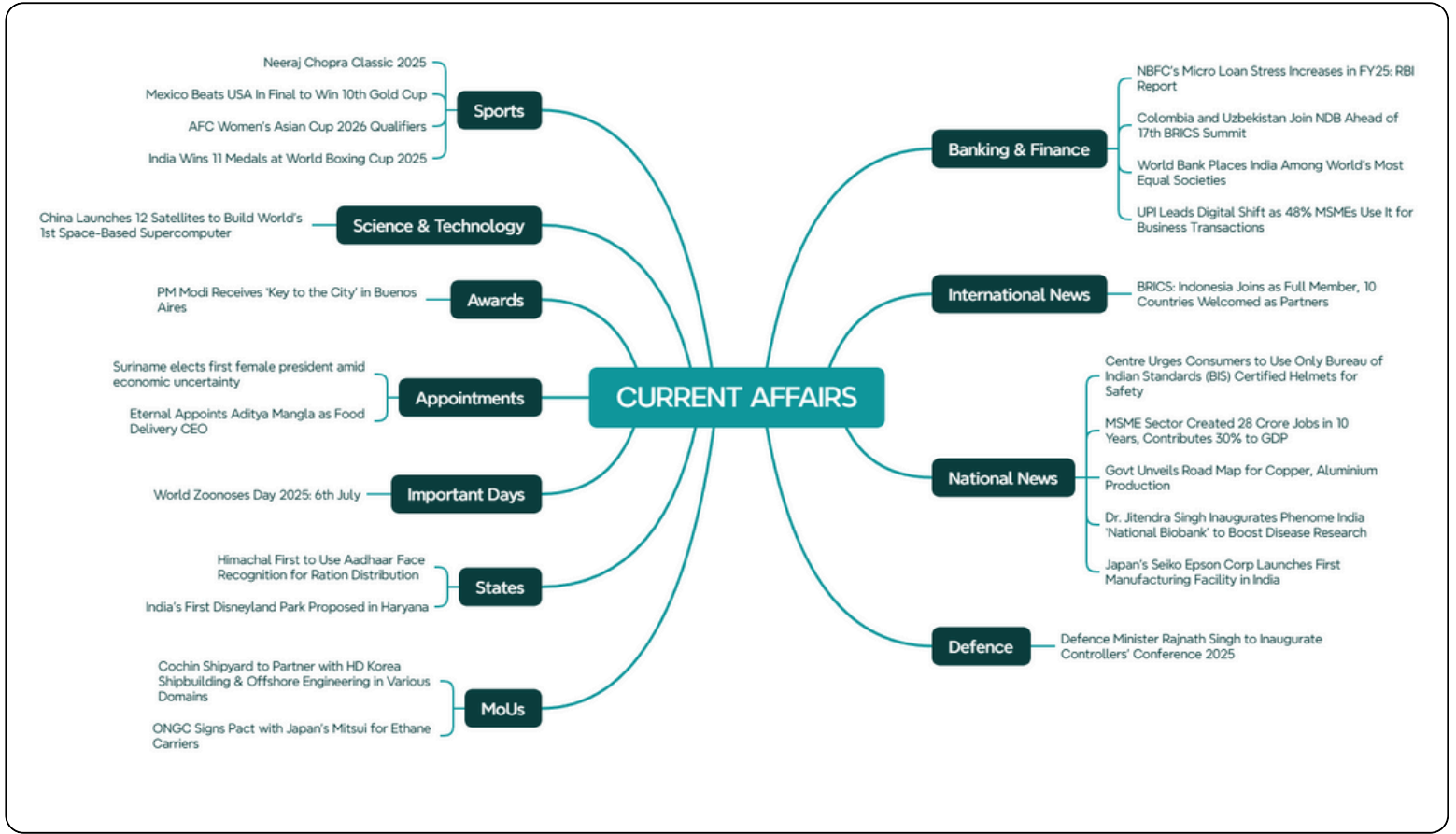
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AD BANNER IMAGE

VISUAL CONNECTORS (MIND-MAP)



Important Q&A

|    |                                                                                                                 |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q1 | Who presented the 'Key to the City of Buenos Aires' to PM Narendra Modi?                                        |
| Q2 | How many satellites did China launch in the initial phase to build the world's first space-based supercomputer? |
| Q3 | Where is India's first Disneyland Park proposed to be located?                                                  |
| Q4 | What is the theme of the Controllers' Conference 2025 inaugurated by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh?            |
| Q5 | Which two countries officially joined the New Development Bank (NDB) in 2025?                                   |



## BANKING &amp; FINANCE

## NBFC's Micro Loan Stress Increases in FY25: RBI Report



- **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) – Stress in Microfinance**
  - **Stressed Assets (Microfinance Sector including NBFC-MFIs):**
    - Increased to: **5.9%** (as of March 2025)
    - Earlier (Sept 2024): **3.9%**
  - **Rising Slippage Ratios & Loan Write-Offs**
    - **Upper Layer NBFCs:**
      - Write-Offs Surge: From ~50% (June 2022) To **72.9%** (March 2025)
    - **Middle Layer NBFCs:**
      - Write-Offs Increase: From ~20% (June 2022) To **38.7%** (March 2025)
    - **Combined (Upper + Middle Layer NBFCs):**
      - Write-Offs Increased: From ~20% (June 2022) To **46.4%** (March 2025)

## Colombia and Uzbekistan Join NDB Ahead of 17th BRICS Summit



- **New Development Bank (NDB) – Expansion Update (2025)**
  - Colombia and Uzbekistan have officially joined the NDB.
  - **Total Member Countries Now: 11**
- **About NDB (New Development Bank)**
  - **Purpose:** To fund infrastructure and sustainable development in emerging economies.
  - **Established in:** 2015 by the original BRICS nations.
  - **Original BRICS Members:** Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa
  - **Other Existing Members:** Bangladesh, United Arab Emirates (UAE), Egypt, and Algeria
  - **New Members (2025):** Colombia and Uzbekistan
  - **Headquarters:** Shanghai, China
- **10th Annual Meeting of NDB BoG – Key Highlights (2025)**
  - **Chairperson of the Meeting:** H.E. Mr. Fernando Haddad, Minister of Finance, Brazil and NDB Governor for Brazil.
  - **THEME:** “Driving Development: Fostering Innovation, Cooperation, and Impact through a Multilateral Development Bank for the Global South”

- **New Appointment:**
  - Roman Serov (Russia) appointed as Vice-President of NDB
  - Term: Sept 7, 2025 – Sept 6, 2030
- **Elections in Board of Governor:**
  - Anton Siluanov, Minister of Finance, Russia, elected as Chairperson of BoG
  - Nirmala Sitharaman, Finance Minister, India, elected as Vice-Chairperson of BoG
  - Tenure: Both will serve until the end of the 11th Annual Meeting in 2026
- **Next Host Country:** Russia will host the 11th Annual Meeting of NDB in 2026
- **New Development Bank (NDB) – Key Facts**
  - **Formerly known as:** BRICS Development Bank
  - **Established by:** BRICS nations (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa)
  - **Purpose:** To finance infrastructure and sustainable development projects in Emerging Markets and Developing Countries (EMDCs)
  - **Capital Structure:**
    - Initial authorized capital: USD 100 billion
    - Divided into: 1 million shares
    - Value per share: USD 100,000
  - **Leadership:**
    - First President: K.V. Kamath (India) – served from 2015 to 2020
    - Current President (2025): Dilma Rousseff (Brazil)

## World Bank Places India Among World's Most Equal Societies



- **Report Name:** Spring 2025 Poverty and Equity Brief
- **Released by:** World Bank
- **India: Key Highlights**
  - **Gini Index:** 25.5 (2022-23)
    - **4th most equal society globally**
    - Countries ahead: Slovak Republic (24.1), Slovenia (24.3), Belarus (24.4)
    - Category: Moderately Low Inequality (Gini between 25–30)
- **Gini Index – What It Means**
  - Scale: 0 (perfect equality) to 100 (absolute inequality)
  - Lower score = more equality
- **Poverty Reduction in India**
  - Extreme poverty (below \$2.15/day):
    - Dropped from 16.2% (2011-12) to **2.3%** (2022-23)

- **Urban vs Rural Poverty**
  - Rural extreme poverty: 2.8%
  - Urban extreme poverty: 1.1%
  - Rural-urban gap reduced: From 7.7 percentage points to **1.7 p.p.**
  - Annual decline: 16%
- **Prosperity Gap:** 5.8 (2022-23)
- **Impact**
  - **171 million Indians lifted out of extreme poverty** in the last decade
  - 5 states (Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh):
    - Accounted for 65% of poor (2011-12)
    - Contributed to 2/3rd of poverty reduction

## UPI Leads Digital Shift as 48% MSMEs Use It for Business Transactions



- **Report Name:** MSME Digital Index Report
- **Released by:** PayNearby (DPIIT-certified fintech company)
- **Focus:** Digital adoption among MSMEs
- **Key Highlights**
  - **Digital Payment Preferences:**
    - **48% of MSMEs prefer UPI** for business transactions
    - 39% use Aadhaar-enabled banking
    - Women-led businesses: Aadhaar use higher at 42%
  - **Smartphone Usage:**
    - **71% of MSME users rely on smartphones** as their main business tool
    - 84% of women entrepreneurs primarily use smartphones for managing operations

## INTERNATIONAL NEWS

## BRICS: Indonesia Joins as Full Member, 10 Countries Welcomed as Partners



- **BRICS Expansion and 17th Summit Highlights (2025)**
  - **Event:** 17th BRICS Summit
  - **Location:** Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
  - **BRICS Chairship:** Brazil (from January 1, 2025)
  - **Theme:** “Strengthening Global South Cooperation for More Inclusive and Sustainable Governance”





- **New Membership Updates**
  - **Indonesia:** Became a full member of BRICS in January 2025
  - **Partner Countries (10):** Belarus, Bolivia, Kazakhstan, Nigeria, Malaysia, Thailand, Cuba, Vietnam, Uganda, and Uzbekistan
  - **Current BRICS Member Countries (11 as of 2025):**
    - Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa (Original 5)
    - Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE (joined Jan 1, 2024)
    - Indonesia (joined Jan 1, 2025)
  - **Upcoming Host:** India will host the 18th BRICS Summit in 2026
- **About BRICS**
  - **Established:** As BRIC in 2006 during the G8 Outreach Summit
  - **First BRIC Summit:** 2009, in Russia
  - **South Africa joined:** 2010, forming BRICS

### NATIONAL NEWS

## Centre Urges Consumers to Use Only Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) Certified Helmets for Safety



- **BIS-Certified Helmets – Key Highlights**
  - **Issued by:** Department of Consumer Affairs & Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)
  - **QCO Enforced Since:** 2021
  - **Applicable Standard:** IS 4151:2015
  - **Licensed Manufacturers (June 2025):** 176 across India
- **Why BIS-Certified Helmets Matter**
  - **Helmet Use:** Mandatory under Motor Vehicles Act, 1988
  - **Substandard Helmets:** Compromise safety and protection
  - **Certified Helmets:** Must have ISI Mark as per BIS standards
- **Consumer Empowerment Tools**
  - Check manufacturer license status on BIS Care App and BIS Portal
  - Lodge helmet-related complaints via BIS Care App

## MSME Sector Created 28 Crore Jobs in 10 Years, Contributes 30% to GDP



- **MSME Ministry Achievements (Last 10 Years)**
  - **Employment Generated:** Over 28 crore employment opportunities created.
  - **Contribution to GDP:** ~30%.

- **Contribution to Manufacturing Sector:** 35.4%.
- **Contribution to Exports:** 45.73% of India's total exports.
- **Growth in MSME Units & Finance**
  - **Registered MSME Units:**
    - Increased **15 times** in last 5 years.
    - Total units now: **6.53 crore**.
  - **Loan Disbursal to MSMEs:**
    - Increased **4 times** over last 5 years.
- **Employment Schemes & Impact**
  - **PM Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP):**
    - 80+ lakh jobs created.
    - 80% of these jobs in rural areas.
  - **PM Vishwakarma Scheme:**
    - Aimed at informal/unorganised sector artisans.
    - ~1 million registered artisans have received toolkit incentives.

## Govt Unveils Road Map for Copper, Aluminium Production



- **Copper and Aluminium Vision Documents – Key Highlights**
  - **Event:** International Conference on Sustainable and Responsible Mining
  - **Location:** Hyderabad
  - **Released by:** Union Coal and Mines Minister G. Kishan Reddy
  - **Organizer:** Indian National Committee of the World Mining Congress
- **Copper Vision Document (India@2047)**
  - **Projected Demand:** Six-fold increase by 2047
  - **Target:** Add 5 million tonnes per annum (MTPA) of smelting and refining capacity by 2030
  - **Status:** Copper is now notified as a critical mineral in India
- **Aluminium Vision Document (India@2047)**
  - **Production Goal:** Scale up aluminium production six-fold by 2047
  - **Bauxite Production Target:** Expand capacity to 150 MTPA

## Dr. Jitendra Singh Inaugurates Phenome India 'National Biobank' to Boost Disease Research



- **Phenome India 'National Biobank' – Key Highlights**
  - **Location:** CSIR-Institute of Genomics and Integrative Biology, New Delhi
  - **Inaugurated by:** Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State for Science and Technology
  - **Project:** Part of the Phenome India Project
- **Key Features**
  - **Purpose:** National Biobank to support a long-term cohort study
  - **Participants:** Collects data from 10,000 individuals across India
  - **Data Collected:**
    - Genomic data
    - Lifestyle information
    - Clinical health records
- **Objectives**
  - Track health trajectories over years
  - Identify gene-environment interactions
  - Understand disease patterns in the Indian population
  - Enhance personalized medicine and response to therapy

## Japan's Seiko Epson Corp Launches First Manufacturing Facility in India



- **Epson Opens First Printer Manufacturing Facility in India**
  - **Company:** Epson (part of Japan-based Seiko Epson Corporation)
  - **Event:** Opened its first ink tank printer manufacturing facility in India
  - **Location:** Sriperumbudur, Chennai, Tamil Nadu
  - **Operations Start:** October 2025
  - **Partner:** RIKUN (Epson's manufacturing partner)
- **Factory Highlights:**
  - **Production Capacity:** 20,000 printers/month
  - **Focus Product:** EcoTank printers (high-capacity, cartridge-free, environment-friendly)

### DEFENCE

## Defence Minister Rajnath Singh to Inaugurate Controllers' Conference 2025



- **Defence Minister Rajnath Singh to Inaugurate Controllers' Conference 2025 in New Delhi**





- **Date:** 7th July 2025
- **Host:** Defence Accounts Department (DAD)
- **Duration:** 3 days
- **Theme:** "Transforming Financial Advice, Payment, Audit, and Accounting through Defence Finance and Economics"

#### MOU'S

### Cochin Shipyard to Partner with HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering in Various Domains



- **Parties Involved:**
  - Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)
  - HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering Co. Ltd. (KSOE)
- **Type:** Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)
- **Objectives of the Collaboration**
  - Long-term cooperation in shipbuilding and maritime development
  - Explore newbuilding opportunities
  - Share technical expertise to improve capabilities
  - Enhance productivity in shipyard operations
  - Upskill workforce through joint initiatives
- **Strategic Significance**
  - Aligned with India's Maritime India Vision 2030
  - Supports India's ambition to become a global maritime hub

### ONGC Signs Pact with Japan's Mitsui for Ethane Carriers



- **Parties Involved:**
  - Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC)
  - Mitsui OSK Lines (Japan)
- **Purpose:**
  - To construct two very large ethane carriers
  - To import petrochemical feedstock (ethane) for ONGC's subsidiary
- **Background:**
  - Addresses changing LNG composition from Qatar
  - Ensures steady ethane supply for ONGC's petrochemical plant
- **Timeline:** Ethane imports expected to begin by mid-2028

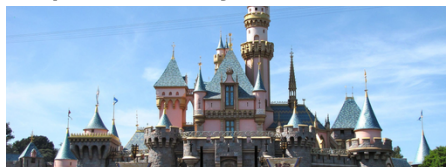
#### STATES

### Himachal First to Use Aadhaar Face Recognition for Ration Distribution



- **State:** Himachal Pradesh
- **Initiative:** Aadhaar-based Face Authentication (FaceAuth)
- **Sector:** Public Distribution System (PDS)
- **Implemented by:** Department of Food and Civil Supplies, Himachal Pradesh
- **Key Highlights:**
  - Himachal Pradesh became the first state in India to introduce facial recognition-based authentication for ration distribution under PDS.
  - Until now, PDS authentication was done using OTP or fingerprint/iris biometrics.
  - However, these methods often faced issues like SMS delivery failures and biometric mismatches at the UIDAI level.
  - The new FaceAuth system uses a mobile camera through an app installed on the fair price shop (FPS) owner's smartphone to verify the identity of the beneficiary via facial scan linked to Aadhaar.

### India's First Disneyland Park Proposed in Haryana



- **India's First Disneyland Park - Proposed in Manesar, Haryana**
  - **Announced by:** Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini
  - **Location:** Near Pachgaon Chowk, Manesar, Haryana
  - **Project Area:** 500 acres
  - **Status:** Preliminary talks ongoing with Disney

#### APPOINTMENTS

### Suriname elects first female president amid economic uncertainty



- Suriname has elected **Jennifer Geerlings-Simons** as its first female president, with parliament backing the 71-year-old physician and lawmaker to lead the crisis-hit South American nation.

### Eternal Appoints Aditya Mangla as Food Delivery CEO



- Eternal, the company that owns Zomato, selected **Aditya Mangla** as the new CEO of its food delivery unit

#### AWARDS

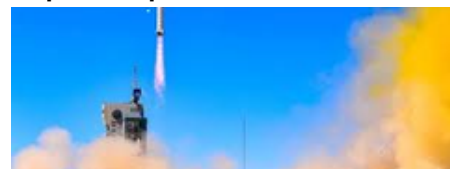
### PM Modi Receives 'Key to the City' in Buenos Aires



- **PM Modi Honoured in Argentina**
  - **Event:** PM Narendra Modi presented with the 'Key to the City of Buenos Aires'
  - **Presented by:** Jorge Macri, Head of the City Government of Buenos Aires
  - **Occasion:** Visit to Buenos Aires, Argentina
- **Tributes Paid**
  - PM Modi paid homage to:
    - Mahatma Gandhi
    - Rabindranath Tagore (Tagore visited Argentina in 1924)

#### SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

### China Launches 12 Satellites to Build World's 1st Space-Based Supercomputer

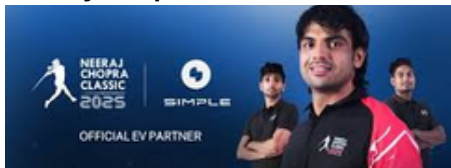


- **China Launches First Phase of Three-Body Computing Constellation**
  - **Project Overview:**
    - **Name:** Constellation Three-Body
    - **Type:** Space-based supercomputing network
    - **Global First:** First-ever attempt to build a supercomputer constellation in space
  - **First Launch Details:**
    - **Satellites Launched:** 12 (Initial phase)
    - **Total Planned:** 2,800 satellites
  - **Developers/Partners:**
    - Zhejiang Lab (Project lead)
    - ADA Space
    - Zhijiang Laboratory
    - Neijiang High-Tech Zone
- **Key Features:**
  - Satellites will:
    - Autonomously collect and process data
    - Operate without dependence





- on ground stations
- **Goal:** Enable real-time, high-volume data processing in space

**SPORTS****Neeraj Chopra Classic 2025**

- **Location:** Sree Kanteerava Stadium in Bengaluru
- **Gold:** Neeraj Chopra (86.18m)
- **Silver medal:** Julius Yego (Kenya)
- **Bronze:** Rumesh Pathirage (Sri Lanka)

**Mexico Beats USA In Final to Win 10th Gold Cup**

- **Mexico Clinches 10th CONCACAF Gold Cup Title by Defeating USA 2-1 in Final**
  - **Final held at:** NRG Stadium, Houston, on Sunday.
  - Mexico secures a 2-1 victory over the United States in a closely contested final.
  - Marks Mexico's 10th Gold Cup title, reinforcing its dominance in CONCACAF football ahead of the upcoming FIFA World Cup.

**AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026 Qualifiers**

- **India Qualifies for AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026**
  - **Event:** AFC Women's Asian Cup 2026 Qualifiers – Group B
  - **Match:** India beat hosts Thailand 2-1
  - **Venue:** 700th Anniversary of Chiang Mai Stadium, Thailand
  - **Outcome:** India qualified for the main event in 2026
  - **Historical Context:** India last qualified directly for the main draw of the AFC Women's Asian Cup in 2003

**India Wins 11 Medals at World Boxing Cup 2025**

- **India Registers Best-Ever Performance at World Boxing Cup 2025 in Astana, Kazakhstan**
  - Indian women boxers Sakshi (54kg), Jaismine (57kg), and Nupur (80+kg) clinched gold medals.

- India finishes with **11 medals: 3 Gold, 5 Silver, 3 Bronze** — its highest-ever tally at the event.
- Sakshi defeated Yosline Perez (USA), Jaismine beat Jucielen Romeu (Brazil), and Nupur overpowered Yeldana Talipova (Kazakhstan).

**ANSWERS**

|   |                                                                                                       |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Jorge Macri                                                                                           |
| 2 | 12 Satellites                                                                                         |
| 3 | Manesar, Haryana                                                                                      |
| 4 | "Transforming Financial Advice, Payment, Audit, and Accounting through Defence Finance and Economics" |
| 5 | Colombia and Uzbekistan                                                                               |

**AD BANNER IMAGE**